last vestiges of support for the Rohingya community. A number of aid agencies are prepared to comply with government restrictions in order to carry on other work in the region.

## *Why did these events occur?*

It is clear that while the Rohingyas were the main specific target in 2012–13, there has been widespread violence against other Muslim communities in Myanmar. The underlying dynamic driving these events has been the alliance between extremist Buddhist monks, elements of the old military regime, and the silence of the official opposition. In effect, a multi-cultural, multi-confessional state is being treated as a Buddhist state dominated by one 'Burmese' culture that only includes a specific set of ethnic groups and explicitly excludes others. This way of defining the Burmese national identity automatically leaves a group like the Rohingyas outside of the state and without legal rights to the protection that states normally afford their citizens. This is a significant precondition for further violence, and in the minds of the extremist Buddhist aggressors, a further rationalisation for their actions. In this conception of the state, it is certainly already the case that the Rohingyas have no place in the state of Myanmar. And from there, saying that they also have no place within the *territory* of the state follows quite naturally.

One solution favoured by the regime was to separate the Buddhist and Muslim communities in Rakhine, perhaps hoping that this would reduce friction between the groups. Taken to its extreme, this decision has led to the systematic creation of what are becoming permanent refugee camps within Rakhine. These are scattered across the areas where Rohingya villages and townships used to exist, but most are concentrated in the coastal area to the north of Sittwe.